

The European Job Search Checklist

What recruiters actually check before they call you. 12 things most international applicants miss.

Work authorization is stated, not clearly

01

"Open to relocation" is not the same as stating whether you need sponsorship. Say it in one direct line, on the CV and on LinkedIn.

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Language levels are honest and matched to the market

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Recruiters check the local language requirement before anything else for client-facing roles. An inflated level gets caught in the first phone call.

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No unexplained employment gaps

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A gap without a line of context reads as inactivity, even when you were studying, relocating, or building something. One sentence closes the question before it is asked.

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No overlapping dates without explanation

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Two full-time roles running in the same window will stop a recruiter cold unless it is clearly labelled as part-time, freelance, or a side project.

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Job titles match everywhere

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CV, LinkedIn, and what you say out loud should all agree. A title upgrade that is not backed by the experience section undermines trust fast.

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One clear direction, not three

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A CV built for three different career paths at once usually convinces a recruiter of none of them. Pick the lead story; mention the rest in conversation.

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Format survives an ATS

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Two-column layouts, text boxes, and icons can lose information when parsed. Single column, standard fonts, and clear headings parse cleanly.

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No leftover internal markers

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"Confidential" or "Not for external distribution" footers pulled from an old template raise a compliance flag before anyone reads a word.

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Achievements, not just duties

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"Responsible for reporting" tells a recruiter nothing. "Cut reporting time by 30% across six teams" tells them exactly what you are worth.

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Specific expertise is visible, not buried

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Named brands, named certifications, named technical processes belong near the top. If it is only in a bullet three roles down, it is not doing its job.

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LinkedIn and CV actually align, and links work

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A broken LinkedIn link or a profile that contradicts the CV is one of the fastest ways to lose credibility with almost no effort to fix.

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No personal details recruiters do not need

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Date of birth, marital status, and a photo you are unsure about can invite bias or trip ATS systems depending on the market. When in doubt, leave it out.

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